Teacher guide & answers

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Connect

Ask: What makes it hard to listen to someone? Introduce Michael as an imagined child, not a Bible character. Let children name distractions without shaming them.

Loved first

Read Matthew 6:6 and 1 John 4:19. Explain: the Father welcomes personal relationship, not a performance. Read Romans 5:8: Christ died for sinners. Prayer does not buy love or salvation. “In secret” means away from an audience, not hiding unsafe secrets from trusted adults.

Investigate Jesus’ example

Read Mark 1:35 and explain “desolate.” Children mark the actual verse with three different pencil marks. Read Luke 6:12–13; reconstruct the order and point to the supporting words. Jesus prayed before choosing the twelve. Children need sleep; this is not a command to stay awake. Plan around Michael’s game and breakfast, then explain why the plan helps.

Search, notice, discuss

Read Luke 11:1 in full. Invite children to search the imaginary ancient scene, circle eight kinds of modern objects, then color it. The puzzle is about noticing historical mismatches, not calling everyday objects sinful. Return to the lesson: Jesus made time to pray. What could you put aside to talk with your Father?

Joy and response

Read Psalm 63:3 and 1 Thessalonians 5:17. God’s steadfast love is His faithful love. Pray during ordinary life; quiet morning time is a helpful rhythm, not the only valid time. Color and complete one personal plan. Accept drawings or dictated answers.

Pray together

Invite voluntary one-sentence thanks or requests. Passing is fine. Return to Michael: what changed? Encourage a short, parent-supported quiet time tomorrow, without promises of prizes or perfect days.

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Page 2 · Mark the evidence

Circle “very early in the morning, while it was still dark”; box “a desolate place”; underline “he prayed”. Accept a larger time phrase including “And rising”. All marks belong in the printed verse, not in a separate matching list.

Page 2 · Restore the order

Numbers beside the printed events: 3, 1, 2. First the mountain, then prayer through the night, then choosing the twelve when day came. Have children point to “all night” and “when day came”.

Page 2 · Make a workable plan

Example: turn off the game, sit on the bedroom chair, and pray before breakfast. Why: fewer distractions help Michael pay attention to his Father. Also accept a short prayer now and quiet time after breakfast. Do not make prayer compete with helping the family. Drawings or dictated plans count.

Page 3 · Eight kinds of modern objects

1. Wristwatch on an olive branch, upper left. 2. Electric bulb under the house eave, upper right. 3. Zippered backpack beside the door. 4. Car tire behind the wall on the left. 5. Toothbrush in the small cup on the stone ledge, right of Jesus. 6. Modern lace-up sneakers on the path, lower left (count the pair as one kind). 7. Soccer ball among the stones, lower right. 8. Metal table fork among the flowers, near the bottom center.

Support and discussion

Let children search without a list first. If needed, suggest a region of the picture rather than naming an answer. Ask older children to explain the mismatch. Sneakers count as one kind; accept one circle around the pair. The scene is illustrative, not a claim about the exact place Jesus prayed. Page 4 responses are personal.